

THE REPORT



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The Magazine of the International Institute of Marine Surveying

THE MARINE SURVEYOR AND THE GUT FEELING

**THE
HARMONISED
FUTURE
OF ELECTRIC
BOATING**

**HOW ARE
MOTORBOATS
MADE?**

JUSTIFYING SUSTAINABLE SUPERYACHT REFITS

Container ship fires are pushing salvors to the limit

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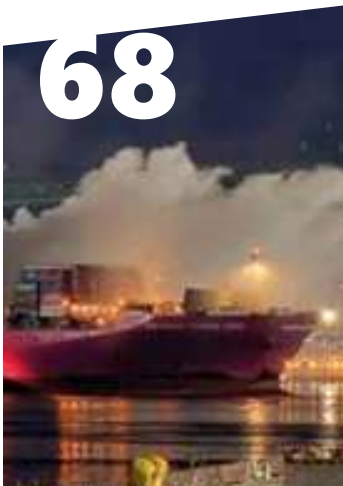
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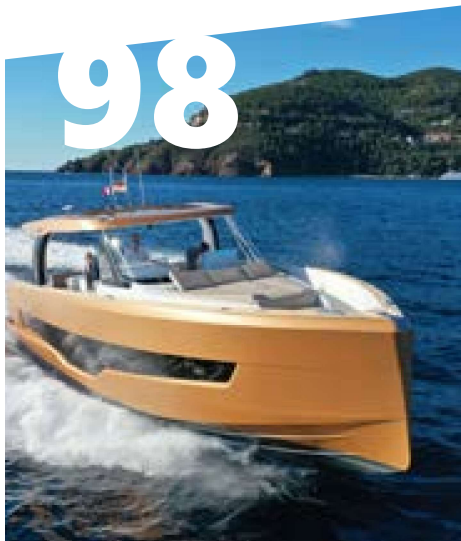
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EDITOR'S LETTER

Dear Member and Fellow Maritime Professionals

I am pleased to welcome you to the September 2026 edition of The Report Magazine.

The onslaught of AI technology has taken the world by storm in recent years, and its effects are being profoundly witnessed in every area of the shipping and boating industries. It is clear that what we are seeing is a series of seismic events that are challenging and reshaping the way the maritime industry thinks and operates. I believe personally this will be the biggest shift we have seen in our lifetimes.

With AI firmly in mind, I have authored an article entitled '*Spotlight on emerging AI technology in the maritime sector*' (page 54). I have drawn together a series of stories into one article, each of which demonstrates the impact AI is having. In a similar vein, I am grateful to Venkat Krishna Soundararaja who has penned a fascinating article - '*AI at Sea: From Maritime Hype to Operational Readiness*' (page 74).

In truth, whatever we think about AI, it is here to stay, and these two articles provide a valuable insight into the challenges and changes we can expect to see as it emerges.

Sticking with new technologies, electric vehicle lithium-ion battery fires on ships continue to exercise minds. The Cargo Incident Notification System (CINS) has released its latest guidance for shipping lithium-ion cells and batteries in containers. This essential guidance and advice carry great authority – see page 64.

I read many articles about the importance and value of Port State Control inspections. The author of the article entitled, '*Seven pillars for improved PSC performance*' (page 128) argues that the fundamentals of strong PSC performance remain unchanged. It details seven key areas that need careful thinking about and understanding to ensure a successful outcome.

'*How are motorboats made?*' (page 98) is written by the team at Fjord boats. It is a deep dive into how modern-day motorboats are constructed from concept to blueprint to manufacture. It lifts the lid and gives a fascinating insight into twenty first century boatbuilding techniques.

End of life boats are abandoned and can be found everywhere. There are literally millions of GRP boats in Europe alone that are past their sell by date and no longer fit for use. This is a subject I have championed before and, although it remains an

immense problem, there is movement developing in this area. In the article '*Large scale required to improve boat recycling efficiency*', the author takes a long hard look at how things are scaling up to meet this challenge in what is, let's face it, a global issue.

The article entitled '*The Marine Surveyor and the Gut Feeling*' by Hans de Koning, MBA MIIMS on page 137 certainly grabbed my attention when it was submitted for publication. Hans argues that these days marine surveyors can be led by gut feeling at times and he is rightly concerned what happens when objective evidence is avoided, overlooked or ignored. He has a valid point!

In her feature '*The Future of Sustainable Marine Manufacturing*', (see page 105), journalist Krystina Skibo admits that while "going green" is the phrase of the day, the path to true sustainability on the water is proving to be less of a sprint and more of a difficult upstream row.

As always, I am immensely grateful to all those who have contributed to this edition of The Report Magazine and hope you will find articles and content to inspire and educate you further.

Survey well,

Mike Schwarz
Chief Executive Officer